

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Wiki Jargon

Stub: A stub is an article that stops short of giving an encyclopaedic coverage of any topic. The article is usually very short, giving a very brief overview of the topic without an index or sub sections.

Wikify: Many articles are added without the markup language (known as wiki markup) used by wikis and do not follow the formatting guidelines of the wiki. To wikify an article means to format the content as a wiki.

Patrols: Patrols are units of wiki editors who regularly go through a class or category of articles and take any reasonable actions to improve their quality. Most patrollers are humans, but there are a few bots as well, programmed to automatically enhance the content of articles.

Cleanup: A cleanup is the term used by image editors on a wiki to enhance the quality of an image. This usually involves removing distracting backgrounds, color correction or using an image of a higher resolution.

Forking: Forking is the practice of lifting or copying an article from one wiki, and pasting it onto another and editing it to suit the needs of the wiki that it is copied to. The GNU licences on wiki articles makes this a legitimate practice.

Collaboration: A bunch of people combining their creative efforts towards a portal or a class of articles is known as collaboration.

Usage: Was *patrolling* the Culture and Arts pages of Wikipedia, and came across quite a few *stubs* and a few images that need a *cleanup*. Many pages on Uncyclopedia are *forked* from wikipedia, and some of them need to be *wikified* by *collaboration*.

Wild Wild Web

Boredom Killer

The inane, weird and sometimes hilarious underbelly of the Web can be accessed from www.i-am-bored.com—the site is constantly updated, and never fails to deliver a dose of refreshing miscellany.

Check out the links in the weird or tech category. You can also login to keep track of your favourites if you end up being a regular.

Homepage Surfer

www.coolhomepages.com keeps track of the cutting edge in Web page design. Most of the sites here are online portfolios of designers, studios or artists, and each site has a unique approach in terms of interface and navigation. These sites use flash or java in innovative ways, and many are content heavy with videos and special effects integrated into the site

layout. Beware though; many of the sites here are heavy on bandwidth.

Loony Toons Junkie

Which firm sells anti-nightmare machines, strait-jacket ejecting bazookas, jet-propelled pogo sticks and rocket powered roller skates? ACME, of course. Head over to home.nc.rr.com/tuco/looney/acme/acme.html and you will find a complete catalogue of Acme products. Pity you can't buy them.

DUBYA ESCAPES RTI

White House Server Loses E-mail

Anyone in their right minds would assume that the White House is one of the safest, most secure and technologically proficient places to receive and send e-mails in the world. Well, they would assume wrong, because as many as 225 days of e-mail have mysteriously gone missing from the White House servers. This is not thanks to some renegade hacker from Afghanistan, there is, in fact no one to blame but the White House staff themselves.

While on the one hand, the White House has asked for bids to make a recovery attempt, on the other, they refuse to admit that the event has even occurred—ignoring all media enquiries on the topic.

It is unlikely that the e-mails are going to be recovered because of the scale of the problem. There is a 9 page document that gives the details about the e-mails stored in 35,000 disaster recovery backup tapes. The recovery efforts

are running into reels of red-tape and going nowhere.

Meanwhile, a fresh angle is thrown in by citizen watchdog groups who claim that the missing data conveniently covers the period of the Iraq violence and the Abu Gharib prison scandal. Those for open legislation have hit a brick wall because of documents being withheld from the common public—as these documents are entirely missing.

Conspiracy Theorists are sure to put this tit-bit of information to good use for their own purposes. Suspiciously, a huge chunk of the 400 million or so e-mails falls bang in the middle of the period of time when the White House was planning to attack Iraq.

The recovery of these e-mails, if at all it ever happens, will easily outlast the term of Bush's presidency.

This at a time when the White House is taking increasing measures to keep track of the hundreds of thousands of e-mails that fly around the Internet each day. We're waiting for the Dubya jokes to start flying.

NOSEY GMAPS

Drunk Man On Google

A man, known only as "Bill" from northern Australia, wanted to go biking with his buddy on the island of Tasmania. Only, before he could do this, his buddy died. So Bill went down to the local bar and had a few drinks, got properly drunk and a bunch of his friends bundled him into a cab and sent him home. After reaching home, he promptly collapsed on his mother's front lawn. On any other day, he would have woken up a few hours later with a splitting headache, and gone inside for a cup of coffee...

Along comes a car, with a guy operating a video camera in the back. The object of the whole setup is to upload entire streets on to the Internet, for Google Map's latest offering, called Street View. Bill eventually gets up, presumably has his cup of coffee, and is well on

Hard Hit...Or Hitting Hard?

August—not the most eventful of months. We had a long, lazy weekend, since the fifteenth was a Friday. After that none of us could seem to get our stuff together. For one, everybody seemed to be coming to work late, and our office looked like a night-shift affair at 10.00 am. Then products we intended to test got delayed, courtesy the heavy rains.

We were hit hard with the loss of Bhaskar Sarma, and Rohan, who just joined us last month, but was bitten by the malaria parasite. Aditya came in though, and saved the day. It's brilliant how so many of our readers, like Aditya, join us and are able to hit the ground running. Of course, he's often seen running for cover in our Q3 deathmatches.

DIGIT DIARY

his way towards recovering from his buddy's death, goes surfing for a while, decides to look up his own home on the Street View offered by Google, and suddenly he sees himself in a right state on the World Wide Web. He was obviously not too happy with it. Bill did not officially complain, but a number of users flagged that part of the site, and Google has since then removed the content—but not before the hilarity of the whole situation made a pint sized celebrity out of him on the Web.

UPGRADE TO XP

Vista Users Like XP Better

Microsoft is trying hard to get people to fall in love with Vista. Despite Vista



being far superior to XP in terms of security, a third of Vista users downgrade to XP according to research firm's CTO Craig Barth in collaboration with InfoWorld. They surveyed more than 3000 computers shipped in the last six months and came to this conclusion. Sometimes, the downgrade was done by the customers once they purchased their computers, but there were instances where vendors such as Dell downgraded their systems based on requests from their customers. Perhaps the most demeaning thing about the whole issue is that a lot of people are not looking at this as a downgrade at all. In their opinion, replacing Vista with XP is actually an *upgrade*!

The deep permeation of XP in the corporate environment is the reason for this. It looks like Microsoft's \$300 million advertising campaign to boost Vista sales isn't helping. ☒

think di9it Blog WATCH

Featured here are snippets from some of the best bloggers who have registered at the Blog Watch section on thinkdigit.com.

If you wish to be featured too, head to www.thinkdigit.com/blogger.php and sign-up.

Milind Koyande

<http://tinyurl.com/5qdb5z>

<http://win-regedit.blogspot.com/2008/08/native-processor-performance-control-in.html>

The following tweak applies to processors with either Intel SpeedStep or AMD PowerNow! Processor performance control technologies. Windows includes inbuilt processor performance control to utilise it more efficiently. Some CPUs that support the aforementioned technologies have trouble with random hangs under XP. Even if you've installed an updated CPU driver, XP might not have enabled it. This hack is for such cases. Navigate to: `HLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\PS3\Parameters`

Here, create a new DWORD value (or modify the existing value) called HackFlags, and edit its value according to the following.

- 0: Disables native XP support
- 1: Use settings inherited from Intel Software during your XP upgrade.
- 5: Allow XP to support all modes when on battery

You will need to restart for the change to take effect.

Jal Desai

<http://tinyurl.com/59m7md>

<http://jal-infotech.blogspot.com/2008/08/flock-powerful-yet-unnoticed-internet.html>

When we think of an Internet browser, the first thing that comes into our mind is Microsoft Internet Explorer.

Too bad. Well, times changed and people migrated to Firefox and then 'flocked' around Opera. I think one should now flock around 'Flock'—ya that's the name they gave it. Flock is an Internet browser that was hiding for all these years, and nobody noticed it.

First of all, it does it all. Casual surfing is awesome with the tabbed interface which almost all browsers have these days. Digging more into the features, it has many many plugins built into it, such as its own RSS Reader, a People sidebar, a cool personalisation facility 'My World' which integrates snippets of Yahoo!, Digg, Flickr, YouTube, etc.